

Nàngásánshù

1	Phonology	1
1.1	Consonants	1
1.2	Vowels	1
1.3	Phonotactics	1
2	Grammar	2
2.1	Work Order	2
2.2	Work Order Marking	3
2.2.1	Work Order and Elision	3
2.3	Adjectives	4
2.3.1	Adverbs	4
2.3.2	Standalone Adjective Phrases (SAPs)	4
2.3.2.1	Invoice	4
2.3.2.2	Extraposition	5
2.3.2.3	SAP Contraction	6
2.3.3	SAPs and Work Order	6
2.4	Nouns	7
2.4.1	Nouns at Work	7
2.4.2	Clause Complements	7
2.5	Compounds	7
2.5.1	Appositions	7
2.6	Pronouns	8
2.6.1	Demonstrative Pronouns	8
2.6.2	Personal Pronouns	8
2.6.2.1	Full Personal Pronouns	9
2.6.2.2	Abridged Personal Pronouns	9
2.6.2.3	Usage Notes	9
2.6.2.4	Distinguishing Personal and Demonstrative Pronouns	9
2.6.3	Numbers	10
2.7	Verbs	10
2.7.1	Tense, Aspect, Mood	10
2.7.2	Dependent Clauses	11
2.7.3	Copula	11
2.7.4	Aspect	11
2.7.5	Moods	12
2.7.6	Evidentiality	12
2.7.7	Compound Verbs	12
2.7.8	Elision	12
2.8	Derivation	12
2.8.1	Vowel Swapping	12
2.9	-rú	12
2.10	Syntax	13
2.10.1	Relative Clauses	13
3	Literary Elvish	13
4	Examples	14
4.1	Simple Glosses	14

4.2	Ferrule Verse	14
4.2.1	Original English Text	14
4.2.2	Poetic English Rendition of the Elvish Adaptation	14
4.2.3	Elvish Adaptation	15
4.2.4	Gloss of the Elvish Adaptation	15
4.2.5	Notes	16
4.2.6	Notes to add to the grammar.	17
4.2.7	Literal Translation of the Elvish Adaptation	17
5	Appearance and Culture	17
5.1	Gender	17
5.2	The Carbonators	18
5.3	Elvish Upper Class	18
5.4	‘Retirement’	18
5.5	Refurbishment	18
5.6	Sleep	19
5.7	Physical Description	19
5.8	Idioms	19
6	Dictionary	20

1 Phonology

Elvish has no rounded vowels or labial consonants as Elves have no lips. They also have a rather stiff tongue, which leads to a lack of apical sounds as well as the palatal and velar places of articulation collapsing together.

All Elvish consonants are egressive, and all vowels are ingressive. This means that the articulation of an Elvish word requires the speaker to constantly flip-flop between breathing in and breathing out.

Due to their extensive and perpetual involvement in and with the Coal mining process, the mouth of an Elf is exceedingly dry and covered in Coal dust, rendering Elvish articulation particularly chalky, grating, and stunted.

1.1 Consonants

	Alveolar	Palato-Velar	Uvulo-Glottal
Nasal			$\text{n}^?$ <n>
Stop	$\text{d} \text{ t}$ <d t>	$\text{c} \text{ k}$ <c g>	ʔ <'>
Fricative	$\text{s} \text{ s}^{\text{h}}$ <s sh>	$\text{ç} \text{ x}$ <ch x>	
Affricate	$\text{ts} \text{ ts}^{\text{h}}$ <ts tsh>	$\text{tch} \text{ tx}$ <tch tx>	
Trill		r <r>	

- ◇ r / r^{h} is a coarticulated palatal-velar trill (yes, Elves can do that)

1.2 Vowels

	Front	Back	Click
Close	$\text{i} \text{ i}^{\text{h}}$ <i í>	$\text{u} \text{ u}^{\text{h}}$ <u ú>	
Open	$\text{a} \text{ a}^{\text{h}}$ <a á>		
Palato-velar			k^{h} <o>

- ◇ Tense/lax distinction. Lax vowels are marked with an acute.
- ◇ Ingressive sounds are considered vowels, and thus, the palatal-velar click is a vowel.
- ◇ Any vowel can be followed by ç^{h} <ç>, which signifies the 'velar quality', e.g. $\text{ú} / \text{ú}^{\text{h}} \text{ç}^{\text{h}} /$.

1.3 Phonotactics

Classes

C = d, t, c, g, s, sh, ch, x, r, n

A = ts, tsh, tch, tx

V = i, í, u, ú, a, á, o

Q = .

Phonotactics

$[\text{C}|\text{A}]\text{V}(\text{Q})((\text{n}|\text{r})([\text{C}'|\text{V}(\text{Q})])|\text{V}(\text{Q})[(\text{n}|\text{r})\text{C}]\text{V}(\text{Q}))$

Example word

$\text{tsh} \text{ ç}^{\text{h}} / \text{t}^{\text{h}} \text{ s}^{\text{h}} \text{ k}^{\text{h}} \text{ ç}^{\text{h}} /$ 'ribbon'

2 Grammar

2.1 Work Order

Animacy is vital to determining word order in Elvish. The highest animacy, and thus primacy in a clause, goes to that which is working the hardest. This is ‘Work Order.’ From highest work order to lowest, the classes are as follows:

1. The Chimney Man (w₁)
In any circumstance in which The Chimney Man is referenced, He will always have the highest Work Order, for He is always working the Hardest. Except for the day after Christmas.
Any *constituents* containing a w₁ word are placed at the very start of the sentence even before the verb and its markers. This excludes any nested phrases with lesser work order, which must be extraposed using SAPs.
2. Coal (w₂)
Coal is considered the most important aspect of Elvish society and thus placed just below The Chimney Man. It is also considered capable of performing more work than any Elf as it generates a lot of energy when burnt (unlike Elves). Amongst Elves, only the Grand Carbonator is assigned a work order of 2 (see § 5.2).
3. Master Carbonator (w₃)
The highest social status that a normal Elf can obtain; the council of Master Carbonators rules over Elvish society and reports directly to the Grand Carbonator (see § 5.2).
4. Collier (w₄)
Highly experienced Elves that have been working in the Coal industry for at least 100 years; these are typically regional overseers. Only Elves at the class of Collier or above enjoy the privilege of having their names capitalised in writing, and only they are entitled to wear cloaks (see § 5.3).
5. Head Miner (w₅)
Elf in charge of a Coal mine.
6. Canary (w₆)
Used for both the lowest class of Elves (i.e. the common Coal miner) as well as the bird.
7. Human Coal Miners (w₇)
Used for human Coal miners.
8. Human Adults (w₈)
Used for any other human adult.
9. Animals (w₉)
Used for any animal.
10. Human Children (w₁₀)
Used for human children (that are not Coal miners). While important to Elvish society as the beneficiaries of their toils, they are deemed the laziest of beings.
11. Everything Else (w₁₁)
Genreally, any inanimate object other than Coal, abstract concepts, etc.

Some words may have work orders that aren’t obvious from their semantics, e.g. the word *shúmq* /ʃhúmq/ ‘retirement’ has work order 4 as it is considered a culturally important part of Elvish society.

ínú /ɪ̞ŋ̊↓Nʔũ↓/ ‘minecart’, which has work order w6, may be referred to later on as *txúnsha xángá* /čkč̞xʰũ̞↓Nʔsʰa↓ č̞xʰv̞̞̞̞↓Nʔjg̞v̞̞̞̞↓/ ‘the thing with work order w6’. This is an alternative to SAPs (see § 2.3.2) and is especially common with numbers and things that have a relatively high work order.

2.3 Adjectives

In sequences of adjectives (which Elves are particularly prone to), the following categories of hierarchy of importance determines the order at which they are uttered:

1. Christmas
2. Coal
3. Elves
4. Work
5. Humans
6. Rest

Adjectives precede the noun they qualify.

2.3.1 Adverbs

Adverbs follow the verb.

2.3.2 Standalone Adjective Phrases (SAPs)

A very common idiom in Elvish is to refer to a noun (phrase) in the domain of discourse by an adjective that describes it, optionally preceded by a work order marker that agrees with the work order of the noun (phrase). Such phrases are known as *standalone adjective phrases* (SAPs) this largely replaces pronouns in Elvish.

SAPs consist of an adjective preceded by a so-called *invoice particle* (see § 2.3.2.1); syntactically, SAPs are treated as though they were nouns; in particular, they may be preceded by the usual noun particles and even other adjectives.

In writing, it is common for the first mention of a noun phrase to be accompanied by one or more adjectives that may later on be used to refer to it.¹ For example, a fat Elf with the name *txqncu* /čkč̞xʰk̞t̞ŋ̊↓Nʔč̞ku̞̞̞̞↓/ might be introduced as *txúdí txqncu* ‘Fat Txqncu’ and then later on referred to as *sí txúdí* /s̞ɪ̞ŋ̊↓ čkč̞xʰũ̞̞̞̞↓d̞ɪ̞↓/ ‘the fat one’, where *sí* is one of the possible invoice particles.

SAPs are capitalised if they refer to a noun that is capitalised.

2.3.2.1 Invoice

The *invoice* is a construction used primarily as part of a SAP. An invoice operates in a similar way to adjective-noun agreement, except that it is really clause-noun agreement. That is, each noun is assigned a ‘tense’ based on its initial phoneme (see Table 2), and the appropriate invoice particle depends on the noun’s inherent tense as well as the syntactic tense of the clause. Tenses are assigned an integer value *v* between 1 and 5.

¹ This is omitted in spoken language when the noun phrase is something that is clearly visible to all interlocutors.

This phrase is ill-formed because *nq̃n* /Nʰeʃ↓Nʰ/ ‘mine’, a noun with work order 6, precedes *rutí* /r̥r̥uʃ↓t̥i↓/ ‘ferrule’, a noun with work order 4. To correct this, we need to move ‘mine’ to the end of the clause, but we can’t simply move the entire enclosing PP as that would change the meaning of the phrase:

ún xúsʊrɔŋgi tchúʼi ta-rutí tsíro nq̃n.

<i>ún</i>	<i>xúsʊrɔŋgi</i>	<i>tchúʼi</i>	<i>ta-rutí</i>	<i>tsíro</i>	<i>nq̃n</i>
ũ↓Nʰ	ç̣xʰũ↓s̥uʃ↓r̥r̥k̥t̥ʃ↓Nʰʃgi↓	ç̣ḳç̣x̣ũʃ↓ʔi↓	t̥a↓r̥r̥uʃ↓t̥i↓	t̥s̥i↓r̥r̥k̥t̥ʃ↓	Nʰeʃ↓Nʰʰ
for	Master Carbonator	three	POSS-ferrule	under	mine

‘three ferrules under the mine for the Master Carbonators’

While well-formed, this movement has changed what NP the PP qualifies. Instead, the proper solution is to replace the problematic noun in the PP with a **SAP**. The noun is then left stranded as far back in the clause as possible, but of course preceding any nouns with lower work order. If there is no adjective qualifying the noun, the adjective *xún* /ç̣xʰũ↓Nʰʰ/ ‘proper’ is used instead. This adjective has no meaning in this context and only serves to provide something the invoice particle can be attached to. Thus, a grammatical rendition of the above might be:

ún xúsʊrɔŋgi tsíro túr xún tchúʼi ta-rutí nq̃n.

<i>ún</i>	<i>xúsʊrɔŋgi</i>	<i>tsíro</i>	<i>túr</i>	<i>xún</i>	<i>tchúʼi</i>	<i>ta-rutí</i>	<i>nq̃n</i>
ũ↓Nʰ	ç̣xʰũ↓s̥uʃ↓r̥r̥k̥t̥ʃ↓Nʰʃgi↓	t̥s̥i↓r̥r̥k̥t̥ʃ↓	t̥úʳʃ↓r̥r̥	ç̣xʰũ↓Nʰʰ	ç̣ḳç̣x̣ũʃ↓ʔi↓	t̥a↓r̥r̥uʃ↓t̥i↓	Nʰeʃ↓Nʰʰ
for	Master Carbonator	under	INVC.O	NULL	three	POSS-ferrule	mine

‘three ferrules for the Master Carbonators under the mine’

2.3.2.3 SAP Contraction

Elvish relative clauses (see § 2.10.1) precede the noun they qualify; Elvish NPs are placed after the verb and thus frequently occur at the end of a clause; adjectives precede the noun they qualify and invoice markers in turn precede adjectives. All of these factors combined can lead to a peculiar constellation wherein a SAP directly precedes the NP it refers to, with the same adjective occurring twice in a row. For example, the phrase ‘mortal men who are doomed to retire’ expressed naively in Elvish would end up being:

%dun c̣a ṣán ṭúṣa úx̣í sḥanú dun túr shardo shardo núgí

<i>dun</i>	<i>c̣a</i>	<i>ṣán</i>	<i>ṭúṣa</i>	<i>úx̣í</i>	<i>sḥanú</i>	<i>dun</i>	<i>túr</i>	<i>shardo</i>	<i>shardo</i>	<i>núgí</i>
ɖuʳ↓Nʰ	ç̣ḳaʃ↓	s̥eʰ↓Nʰ	t̥úʳ↓s̥aʃ↓	úʳʃ↓ç̣xʰʳʃ↓	ʃ̣ḥaʃ↓Nʰʰúʳʃ↓	ɖuʳ↓Nʰ	t̥úʳʃ↓r̥r̥	ʃ̣ḥaʃ↓r̥r̥ɖ̣ḳt̥	ʃ̣ḥaʃ↓r̥r̥ɖ̣ḳt̥	Nʰúʳʃ↓ʃgiʃ↓
NWK	REL	VER	be.destined	MAN	retire	NWK	INV.O	mortal	mortal	human

‘mortal men who are doomed to retire’

This is rather awkward, for which reason most Elves instead opt to omit the duplicate adjective:

dun c̣a ṣán ṭúṣa úx̣í sḥanú dun túr shardo núgí

<i>dun</i>	<i>c̣a</i>	<i>ṣán</i>	<i>ṭúṣa</i>	<i>úx̣í</i>	<i>sḥanú</i>	<i>dun</i>	<i>túr</i>	<i>shardo</i>	<i>núgí</i>
ɖuʳ↓Nʰ	ç̣ḳaʃ↓	s̥eʰ↓Nʰ	t̥úʳ↓s̥aʃ↓	úʳʃ↓ç̣xʰʳʃ↓	ʃ̣ḥaʃ↓Nʰʰúʳʃ↓	ɖuʳ↓Nʰ	t̥úʳʃ↓r̥r̥	ʃ̣ḥaʃ↓r̥r̥ɖ̣ḳt̥	Nʰúʳʃ↓ʃgiʃ↓
NWK	REL	VER	be.destined	MAN	retire	NWK	INV.O	mortal	human

‘mortal men who are doomed to retire’

In this phrase, *shardo* /ʃ̣ḥaʃ↓r̥r̥ɖ̣ḳt̥/ ‘mortal’ does double duty and is part both of the SAP *túr shardo* /t̥úʳʃ↓r̥r̥ ʃ̣ḥaʃ↓r̥r̥ɖ̣ḳt̥/ ‘the mortal ones’ as well as the NP *shardo núgí* /ʃ̣ḥaʃ↓r̥r̥ɖ̣ḳt̥ Nʰúʳʃ↓ʃgiʃ↓/ ‘mortal men’. A sequence of the form ‘INVOICE.PARTICLE ADJECTIVE NOUN’ is usually SAP-contracted.

2.3.3 SAPs and Work Order

SAPs never have an associated work order; that is, barring other syntactic restrictions, they may be placed anywhere, that is, preceding or following other nouns, irrespective of the work order of those nouns or of the noun that the SAP ultimately references.

2.4 Nouns

Elvish nouns are not marked for number or definiteness. However, besides work order markers (see § 2.4.1), there are a number of miscellaneous noun markers that are used to express concepts such as possession.

The following is a list of Elvish noun markers:

- ◇ *ta-* /təv/ (POSS); this is a possessive marker, e.g. *ta-nánnrú* ‘of the Elves’.
- ◇ *rə-* /rə^h/ (COLL); collective/plural marker; Elvish doesn’t normally mark number, but this particle can be used when number marking is relevant—usually if something is the action of the Elves collectively rather than a single Elf—e.g. *rə-nánnrú* ‘multiple Elves’.

2.4.1 Nouns at Work

Nouns are also declined for whether or not they *perform* work. This is *not* the same as work order! Rather, this marks their position as an agent or patient in any given clause. The verb itself is not declined for voice—this information is contained exclusively in the noun phrase:

- ◇ *tchá* /tchá^h/ ‘performs work’ (WRK ‘working’); this is used to mark the agent of a verb that denotes an action that is considered to perform work.
- ◇ *dun* /dun^h/ ‘does not perform work’ (NWK ‘not working’); this is used to mark the agent of a verb that denotes a state or an action that is not considered to perform (worthwhile) work.
- ◇ *úrú* /úrú^h/ ‘has work performed on it’ (WKD ‘worked [on]’); this is used to mark the theme of a verb whose agent is in the WRK form.
- ◇ *úxí* /úxí^h/ ‘is being manipulated in some fashion’ (MAN ‘manipulated’); this is used to mark the theme of a verb whose agent is in the NWK.

This system naturally gives rise to 2 verb classes:

- ◇ ‘working verbs’, whose agent is in the WRK case and whose theme is in the WKD case.
- ◇ ‘lazy verbs’, whose agent is in the NWK case, and whose theme is in the MAN case.

There are also a number of contractions:

- ◇ *tchá* + *úrú* → *tcháúrú* /tcháúrú^h/: reflexive form used with working verbs.
- ◇ *dun* + *úxí* → *dunxí* /dunxí^h/: reflexive form used with lazy verbs.

The verb itself is only inflected for tense (see § 2.7.1).

2.4.2 Clause Complements

The noun work markers can also precede the verb, in which case the clause acts as the agent/theme.

2.5 Compounds

Compound nouns can be expressed by juxtaposition; the modifier comes second, just like in Santaa, e.g. *nánnchun* /nánnchun^h/ ‘head miner’ (lit. ‘miner head’) from *nánnrú* /nánnrú^h/ ‘canary’ and *chunxi* /chunxi^h/ ‘head’. The compound is written without a space, e.g. *cixítuná* /cixítuná^h/ ‘stone hall’, not **cixí tuná*.

2.5.1 Appositions

Appositions and titles are treated like modifiers and thus placed second, following the name.

2.6 Pronouns

2.6.1 Demonstrative Pronouns

There are 5 demonstrative pronouns, each corresponding to a syntactic tense (see § 2.7.1); as many other things, deixis in Elvish is relative: unlike other languages which employ spatial metaphors to express time, Elvish employs temporal expressions to express relations in space.

That is, the demonstrative pronouns in Elvish are formed by combining the preposition *chír* /ç̣̌XI↓f̌Ř/ ‘at, in, on’ with one of the tense morphemes:

1. Awake Tense: *chírsqn* /ç̣̌XI↓f̌Řša^{f̌ǧ}↓N[?]/
2. REM Sleep Tense: *chírnu* /ç̣̌XI↓f̌ŘN[?]u↓/
3. Non-REM Phase 1 Tense: *chírtxí* /ç̣̌XI↓f̌Řcǩç̣̌x^{ȟ}I↓/
4. Non-REM Phase 2 Tense: *chíro* /ç̣̌XI↓f̌Ř^{ǩ}↓/
5. Non-REM Phase 3 Tense: *chírny* /ç̣̌XI↓f̌ŘN[?]u^{f̌ǧ}↓/

The proximal demonstrative pronoun is expressed relative to the syntactic tense of the utterance: the medial demonstrative pronoun by the tense following the proximal one, and the distal demonstrative pronoun by the tense following the medial one. For example, if the utterance is in the REM Sleep Tense, we have:

- ◇ *chírnu* = ‘this’,
- ◇ *chírtxí* = ‘that (medial)’,
- ◇ *chíro* ‘that (distal)’.

In the Non-REM Phase 2 Tense, we instead have:

- ◇ *chíro* = ‘this’,
- ◇ *chírny* = ‘that (medial)’,
- ◇ *chírsqn* ‘that (distal)’.

In reported speech, the direction is reversed, i.e. instead of medial being the tense after proximal and distal being the tense after medial, instead medial is the tense *preceding* proximal, and distal is the tense preceding medial. E.g. the demonstrative pronouns in reported speech that uses the Non-REM Phase 1 Tense would be:

- ◇ *chírnu* = ‘this’,
- ◇ *chírsqn* = ‘that (medial)’,
- ◇ *chírny* = ‘that (distal)’.

Note that it is the only the syntactic tense of the sentence that matters; neither the time of utterance, nor the time at which the utterance is paraphrased, if at all, are relevant here! For example, consider a sentence uttered during the REM Sleep Phase, in which the Non-REM Phase 1 Tense is the syntactic Future Tense. In such a sentence, the medial demonstrative pronoun would be *chíro* /ç̣̌XI↓f̌Ř^{ǩ}↓/, i.e. the Non-REM Phase 2 form; if this sentence is then paraphrased during the Non-REM Phase 3, the syntactic Future Tense would naturally be the Awake Tense, and the medial pronoun would be the tense *before* that (recall that the direction is reversed in reported speech); thus, the correct form would be *chírny* /ç̣̌XI↓f̌ŘN[?]u^{f̌ǧ}↓/, i.e. the Non-REM Phase 3 form.

2.6.2 Personal Pronouns

There are three sets of constructions in Elvish that are jointly referred to as ‘personal pronouns’. While semantically equivalent, their usage is highly dependent on social status, and they are not interchangeable.

2.6.2.1 Full Personal Pronouns

The so-called *full personal pronouns* of Elvish are formed by combining the demonstrative pronouns with the status-appropriate word for ‘Elf’: The proximal demonstrative is used to express the 1st person, the medial to express the 2nd person, and the distal to express the 3rd person. Naturally, this also means that the exact forms of the personal pronouns depend on the syntactic tense of the containing clause (as well as whether direct or reported speech is used).

For example, in a sentence in Non-REM Phase 2 Tense spoken by a Master Carbonator, the closest Elvish equivalent to a word for ‘I’ would be *chíro xúsyrongi* /ç̣x̣i↓ṛḳṭ ç̣x̣ḥú↓ṣuṛg̣i↓ṛḳṭṆʔ̣gi↓/, lit. ‘this Master Carbonator’. Similarly, in a sentence paraphrased in Non-REM Phase 3 Tense, the word ‘it’ in reference to a Collier would be *chírtxí isirongi* /ç̣x̣i↓ṛḳṭç̣x̣ḥi↓i↓ṣi↓ṛḳṭṆʔ̣gi↓/, lit. ‘that Collier’.

2.6.2.2 Abridged Personal Pronouns

There are two forms of ‘abridged’ pronouns: The *high-class* abridged pronouns are formed by combining the demonstratives with the noun *rongi* /ṛḳṭṆʔ̣gi↓/ ‘cloak’. The *low-class* abridged pronouns are identical to the bare demonstratives. Abridged personal pronouns are only used to refer to an Elf at or below one’s own social status.

2.6.2.3 Usage Notes

Which set of personal pronouns is appropriate in what context is dependent on the social status of the speaker (in the 1st person), as well as that of the referents (in the 2nd and 3rd person). There are strict rules that govern the usage of the pronouns. The rules for the 2nd/3rd person pronouns are:

- ◇ The Chimney Man and The Grand Carbonator are never referred to by a pronoun; instead, the entire phrase ‘The Chimney Man’ or ‘The Grand Carbonator’ is repeated. Similarly, Coal is also never referred to by a pronoun; instead, the noun ‘Coal’ is repeated.
- ◇ The full pronouns are used to refer to an Elf of higher social class than one’s own.
- ◇ The abridged pronouns are used to refer to an Elf at or below one’s own social class. The high-class pronouns are used when the referent is at the class of Collier or above, and the low-class pronouns otherwise.
- ◇ Personal pronouns are only used to refer to Elves. For any other beings, objects, concepts, etc., SAPs (see § 2.3.2) are used instead.
- ◇ Additionally, SAPs may be used whenever an abridged pronoun would be appropriate.
- ◇ The *current* status of the referent at the time of utterance is what matters.²
- ◇ Decommissioned Elves are *always* referred to with the low-class pronouns, irrespective of their status before decommissioning.³

The rules for the 1st person pronoun are simpler: In reference to oneself, the full pronouns are used when speaking to someone of higher social status, and the abridged pronouns otherwise. Naturally, Elves at or above the class of Collier use the high-class pronouns and other Elves the low-class pronouns.

2.6.2.4 Distinguishing Personal and Demonstrative Pronouns

Since personal and demonstrative pronouns can be very similar, as the former simply use the latter, there are rules that can be used to distinguish the two; the most important one of these is that a demonstrative that qualifies the noun always follows the noun. For example, assuming we’re in the

² E.g. when talking about an event that happened to a Collier at a time when it was still a Head Miner, one would never use the low-class personal pronouns.

³ This is decommissioning is a punishment for Elves who are considered to have let down Elf society, and by proxy, The Chimney Man, as a whole.

REM phase, we have *chírnu róngi* /ç̣x̣i↓ṛṇʔu↓ṛḳṭf̣g̣Ṇʔgi↓/ ‘I’ (high-class pronoun) vs *róngi chírnu* /ṛḳṭf̣g̣Ṇʔgi↓ç̣x̣i↓ṛṇʔu↓/ ‘this cloak’ (literally).

This is especially important in the context of a zero copula (see § 2.7.3). Consider e.g. *chírtxi tchúrshu* /ç̣x̣i↓ṛḳcḳç̣x̣ḥi↓cḳç̣x̣ụʔi↓ṛṣḥu↓/ ‘you are an idiot’ vs *tchúrshu chírtxi* /cḳç̣x̣ụʔi↓ṛṣḥu↓ç̣x̣i↓ṛḳcḳç̣x̣ḥi↓/ ‘that idiot’.

2.6.3 Numbers

Elvish numbers use the same system as Santaa numbers, except using Elvish words. Cardinals are expressed using the possessive marker, e.g. *tchú’i ta-nánnrú* /cḳç̣x̣ụʔi↓ʔi↓ta↓Ṇʔṿf̣g̣Ṇʔṛụʔi↓/ ‘three Elves’ (lit. ‘three of Elves’).

When a word is used as a number, it loses its work order; that is, the presence of a number does not alter word order, and e.g. a number that would ordinarily be a noun with work order 2 may follow or precede a noun with work order 3.

2.7 Verbs

Verbs are either classified as ‘working’ or ‘lazy’ (see § 2.4.1). Verbs are not inflected for number, only nouns are. In the absence of work order distinction, the default word order is VOS. Verbs generally do not have an associated work order (unless they are derived from a noun) and are generally placed first; the main exception to this is that nouns with work order 1 are always placed first and precede even the verb.

2.7.1 Tense, Aspect, Mood

The Elvish tense system is based on the hibernation cycle of The Chimney Man. This cycle consists of 5 phases. These five phases form the five so-called *syntactic tenses* of Elvish, which are each marked by a particle that precedes the verb (see Table 4).

Phase	Gloss	Time of the Year	Particle
Awake	AWK	Christmas Eve	<i>sqn</i> /ʃaʔi↓Ṇʔ/
REM Sleep	REM	~29 December – 3 May	<i>nun’a</i> /Ṇʔu↓Ṇʔʔa↓/
Non-REM Phase 1	NR1	~4 May – 25 August	<i>txí</i> /cḳç̣x̣ḥi↓/
Non-REM Phase 2	NR2	~26 August – 9 November	<i>ronu</i> /ṛḳṭf̣g̣Ṇʔu↓/
Non-REM Phase 3	NR3	~10 November – 23 December	<i>ronu</i> /ṛḳṭf̣g̣Ṇʔuʔi↓/

Table 4: Syntactic Tenses in Elvish

At any point in time, the Present Tense in Elvish is whatever sleep phase The Chimney Man is in when the utterance is spoken. This is referred to as the *semantic tense* of the utterance. For instance, on 2 February, The Chimney Man is in REM sleep, and thus, a sentence whose syntactic tense is the REM Sleep Tense would have the Present Tense as its semantic tense. In terms of terminology, the term ‘syntactic Present Tense’ in any given context refers to whatever syntactic tense happens to be the Present Tense.

The syntactic tense following the Present Tense is the semantic Future Tense, and the syntactic tense after that forms a Future-in-the-Future. Similarly, the syntactic tense preceding the semantic Present Tense forms the Past Tense, and the syntactic tense before that serves as the Pluperfect.

As nobody truly knows when *exactly* when the Chimney Man falls asleep, the few days following Chrismtas are an enigma to Elvish speakers. They cannot, and out of respect and fear for the Chimney Man, will not express anything related to time. During this time, which often spans from December 25th until December 28th, all tense marking is dropped, and most Elves cease writing entirely, with the upper classes preferring to communicate in Santaa instead. This is known as the ‘Temporal Void’.

Reported Speech that paraphrases an utterance that was uttered during the this time likewise uses no tense marking.

The syntactic tense that follows the Non-REM Phase 3 Tense is the Awake Tense; conversely, syntactic tense preceding the Awake tense is the Non-REM Phase 3 Tense. Thus, if the syntactic Present Tense is the Awake Tense, the syntactic Past Tense would be the Non-REM Phase 3 tense.

Tense in reported speech is relative to the time of paraphrase rather than the time of utterance. For example, a sentence spoken *during* the Non-REM Phase 1 but *in* the REM Sleep Tense is in the Past Tense. If reported speech is used to describe or paraphrase that sentence *during* the Non-REM Phase 2, the speaker would use the Non-REM Phase 1 Tense, since that is now the Past Tense.

Thus, one has to be careful not to confuse tense between direct speech and reported speech. For example, given an utterance that was spoken during Non-REM Phase 1 but *in* Non-REM Phase 2 Tense, that utterance refers to the future. But if such an utterance were erroneously reported in that same tense during Non-REM Phase 3, it would incorrectly refer to the past. Instead, the Awake Tense should be used to paraphrase.

Note that the tenses are relative only to the point of utterance, not to the point in time at which the action or state described by the utterance takes place. For example, during Non-REM Phase 1, if one wanted to refer to an event that took place in November of *last year*, one would use the REM Sleep Tense, since that is the syntactic Past Tense. The fact that Non-REM Phase 2 takes place in November does not mean that it is used to describe things that take place in November.

Since a sentence in a vacuum without any information as to when it was uttered is impossible to extract temporal data from, any Elvish prose, etc. is always accompanied by a date, much like a diary entry would be. The exception to this is information uttered during the Temporal Void, during which the date is customarily omitted.

2.7.2 Dependent Clauses

Semantic tense in dependent clauses is relative to the syntactic tense of the matrix clause. For example, during the REM Sleep Phase, the syntactic Future Tense is the Non-REM Phase 1 Tense. Given a matrix clause in this Future Tense, the syntactic Past Tense in one of its dependent clauses would then be the REM Sleep Tense, even though that very same syntactic tense would normally be the syntactic Present Tense during the REM Sleep Phase.

The rules for reported speech for e.g. pronouns also apply to dependent clauses.

2.7.3 Copula

The Elvish copula is $\emptyset$, i.e. the empty root; that is, to express the copula all verb markers are used as they normally would be, except that the verb is ‘missing’. Even the tense and evidentiality marker may be dropped if elision is applied, or if they’re obvious from context, generally if the sentence is in the Present Tense, leading to a zero copula (see § 2.7.8).

If an entire clause is preceded by an agent/theme marker, a zero copula cannot be used, and at least one verb marker (usually the evidentiality marker) is required.

The copula is neither working nor lazy, and as such, its subject is not marked at all.

2.7.4 Aspect

Aspect marking differs between working verbs and lazy verbs. Working verbs are marked for telicity, i.e. whether the work is done (TEL ‘telic’) or not (ATEL ‘atelic’). Lazy verbs are marked for whether the laziness is continued (CONT ‘continuous’), or returning (HAB ‘habitual’). For working verbs, telic is the default, for lazy verbs, continuous is the default.

- ◇ *tú* /tú[˥]/ (ATEL): marks that a working verb is atelic
- ◇ *dor* /d[˥]˥[˥]/ (HAB): marks that a lazy verb is habitual

Aspect markers directly precede the verb.

2.7.5 Moods

[TODO]

2.7.6 Evidentiality

Evidentiality is split five four categories:

- ◇ *sán* /sə↓N[?]/ (VER ‘veridical’): (as though) decreed by The Chimney Man (truth)
- ◇ *gan* /gə↓N[?]/ (OBS ‘observable’): either directly observable or deduced via reasoning
- ◇ *xin* /x̣ḥi^{ḥ}↓N[?]/ (COM ‘communicated’): communicated by someone (hearsay)
- ◇ *txá* /ṭḳx̣ḥṿ^{ḥ}↓/ (NOR ‘North Pole’): purported to exist (in the North Pole)
- ◇ *tsún* /ṭṣụ^{ḥ}↓N[?]/ (DUB ‘dubious’): purported to exist elsewhere

The ‘default’ evidentiality marker is generally *gan* /gə↓N[?]/; it is commonly used for statements which the speaker considers to be true but which are not self-evident or proven facts.

Statements of fact use the Chimney Man evidentiality—for example, $2 + 2 = 4$ —and so do statements that an Elf is absolutely sure about. The meaning of this evidentiality is closer to ‘as true as though The Chimney Man Himself had decreed it’, and a suitable translation may be ‘most surely’. At the same time, it is of course also used to refer to literal statements made by The Chimney Man.

2.7.7 Compound Verbs

Compound verbs are verbs that consist of a verb proper and some other word, typically a preposition; the theme of such verbs is generally not marked for case.

2.7.8 Elision

When multiple verbs in a row have verb markers in common, those markers are often dropped for any verb after the first. In particular, this often applies to evidentiality markers: if the evidentiality marker of several clauses is the same, all but the first are generally dropped.

2.8 Derivation

2.8.1 Vowel Swapping

A common way to turn a noun into a verb in Elvish (or vice versa) that applies solely to disyllabic words is to swap the vowels, e.g. *nánrú* /N[?]ṿ^{ḥ}↓N[?]ṛ^{ḥ}ụ^{ḥ}↓/ ‘Coal miner’ becomes *núnraq* /N[?]ụ^{ḥ}↓N[?]ṛ^{ḥ}ṿ^{ḥ}↓/ ‘to mine Coal’.

2.9 -rú

The suffix *-rú* /ṛ^{ḥ}ụ^{ḥ}↓/ can be attached to a verb or noun to form an agent noun describing an Elf who performs an action associated with that verb or noun. E.g. from *sqtá* /ṣḳṭ^{ḥ}ta^{ḥ}↓/ ‘to learn’, we get *sqtárrú* /ṣḳṭ^{ḥ}ta^{ḥ}↓ṛ^{ḥ}ụ^{ḥ}↓/ ‘teacher’, and from *nán* /N[?]ṿ^{ḥ}↓N[?]/ ‘Coal mine’, we get *nánrú* /N[?]ṿ^{ḥ}↓N[?]ṛ^{ḥ}ụ^{ḥ}↓/ ‘Coal miner, Elf’.

2.10 Syntax

2.10.1 Relative Clauses

Relative clauses in Elvish are headed by the pronoun *cq* /č̣kaʰḡ↓/ ‘who, what, which, that’. If the relative pronoun is the agent or theme of the predicate of the relative clause, the appropriate agent or theme marker is placed *before* the relative pronoun. Relative clauses always *precede* the noun they qualify.

There are also two variants of relative clauses that are headed by different pronouns: *locative relative clauses*, which are headed by the pronoun *chircq* /č̣xi↓r̥č̣kaʰḡ↓/ ‘where’, and *temporal relative clauses*, which are headed by the pronoun *rjcq* /r̥riʰḡ↓č̣kaʰḡ↓/ ‘when’.

3 Literary Elvish

There are a few differences between spoken and written Elvish. The most striking difference is a natural consequence of the medium: whereas the time of utterance is obvious in a spoken context (as it is just the present day), the time of utterance of a written text is impossible to know unless expressly conveyed to the reader.

The choice as to what syntactic tense denotes the Present Tense is strictly speaking arbitrary, but by convention, it is generally that of the date on which the author wrote or started writing the text. However, for letters or other texts whose primary purpose is to be sent to someone else, the date at which the text is *sent* is used instead. A natural consequence of this is that many Elves cease all writing during the Temporal Void.

When it comes to stories, poems, etc. only the written form of these texts have a fixed syntactic tense. When a story is told by an Elf, it will naturally—and indeed subconsciously without requiring active consideration or effort—rephrase the text by adjusting the syntactic tense relative to the time at which the story is told while preserving the text’s semantic tense.

Since the time of utterance is an integral part of Elvish grammar, it is custom in Elvish literature to introduce every piece of written text with the phrase ‘This Elf declares that’, with the status-appropriate abridged personal pronoun used as the subject. The syntactic tense of this phrase denotes the Present Tense for the rest of the text. E.g. if the text is written by a Collier during the REM sleep phase, the phrase would be:

Gan nun’a tú tshú’á tchá chínu rōngi ...

<i>gan</i>	<i>nun’a</i>	<i>tú</i>	<i>tshú’á</i>	<i>tchá</i>	<i>chínu</i>	<i>rōngi</i>
ʃga↓Nʹ	Nʹu↓Nʹa↓	tú↓	t̥shúʰḡ↓ʔe↓	č̣ḳč̣xeʰḡ↓	č̣xi↓r̥Nʹu↓	r̥r̥ḳ+ʰḡNʹʃgi↓
OBS	REM	ATEL	declare	WRK	this	cloak

‘I declare that ...’¹

This is effectively prefixed to the first sentence of the text proper, thereby forming a new matrix clause around it. As a result, the rest of the first sentence is rendered in reported speech.

¹ Lit. ‘This cloak is observably declaring that ...’

4 Examples

4.1 Simple Glosses

It is assumed that the examples below are spoken on 2 February (i.e. during the REM phase).

Gan nun'a rōsa úxí tá dun txōncu.

gan nun'a rōsa úxí tá dun txōncu
 ʃga↓N' N'w↓N'ʔa↓ ɾɾ^kʃsa↓ ũ^ʃ↓çx^hɾ^ʃ↓ tɐ^ʃ↓ ɖu↓N' c̃kç^hkʃN' c̃kɯ^ʃ↓
 OBS REM slide MAN chimney NWK Txōncu
 'Txōncu slides down the Chimney (and I see it do so).'

Sán san sōtā dishá dun chírsan rōngi úxí chírnū tchúrshu.

sán san sōtā dishá dun chírsan rōngi úxí chírnū tchúrshu
 ʃɐ↓N' ʃa^ʃ↓N' ʃ^kʃtā^ʃ↓ ɖi↓s^hɐ^ʃ↓ ɖu↓N' çxi↓ɾɾsa^ʃ↓N' ɾɾ^kʃN' ʃgi↓ ũ^ʃ↓çx^hɾ^ʃ↓ çxi↓ɾɾN'w↓ c̃kç^hũ^ʃ↓ɾɾs^hu↓
 VER AWK know always NWK DEM.AWK cloak MAN DEM.REM idiot
 'I always knew that you were an idiot.'

Lit. 'This cloak most surely always knew [that] that(MEDIAL) [was observably an] idiot.'

Gan nun'a gūshā dun nānrú chir dāchā.

gan nun'a gūshā dun nānrú chir dāchā
 ʃga↓N' N'w↓N'ʔa↓ ʃgɯ^ʃ↓s^ha^ʃ↓ ɖu↓N' N'ɐ^ʃ↓N' ɾɾũ^ʃ↓ çxi↓ɾɾ ɖɐ^ʃ↓çxa^ʃ↓
 OBS REM crouch NWK Elf on table
 'The Elf crouches on the table.'

4.2 Ferrule Verse

An Elvish adaptation of JRR Tolkien's Ring Verse, as translated and adapted by the Elvish poet *Tōrxí* /t^kʃɾɾçx^hɾ^ʃ/:

4.2.1 Original English Text

*Three Rings for the Elven-kings under the sky,
 Seven for the Dwarf-lords in their halls of stone,
 Nine for Mortal Men doomed to die,
 One for the Dark Lord on his dark throne
 In the Land of Mordor where the Shadows lie.
 One Ring to rule them all, One Ring to find them,
 One Ring to bring them all and in the darkness bind them
 In the Land of Mordor where the Shadows lie.*

4.2.2 Poetic English Rendition of the Elvish Adaptation

*This Elf declares:
 Three Ferrules for the Master Carbonators under the mine,
 Seven for the Colliers in their halls of stone,
 Nine for Mortal Men doomed to retire,
 One for The Chimney Man on His red throne
 At the North Pole where the Shadows lie.
 One Ferrule to rule them all, One Ferrule to find them,*

At the North Pole where the Shadows lie.

4.2.3 Elvish Adaptation

Gan nun'a tú tshú'a tchq chínu róngi.

Úrú gan ún xúsurongi tsíro túr xún tchú'i ta-ryúí nán.

Ўруған ун исиронги чір сұр хун тхадқ irtototon cixitun'a.

Úrú gan txadq̄ cuncutq̄n ún dun cą sán túsq̄ úxí shq̄nú dun týr shardo núgí.

Ún Sántá chír túr isi ta-Sántá úrú gan txadq nangí shindí nurchó

Chír chírcq chónsò dun árxí xún txáqç ánrú.

Ún ta-dorq nangí ta-ruṭí. Ún ta-shunsí úrú txadq shú.

Ún ta-xítj nangí ta-rytí. Ún ta-tsantú chír xurgi

Chír chírcq chonso dun árxi xún txáqq ánrú.

4.2.4 Gloss of the Elvish Adaptation

Gan nun'a tú tshú'á tchạ chírnư rọngi.

gan nun'a tú tshú'á tchá chírnú róngi
 ʃga↓N' N'w↓N'ʔa↓ tũ↓ tsh^hx^hʃg↓ʔe ʔk̠çx^heʃg↓ ʔxi↓ʔrn'w↓ ʔr^{kʰ}ʃg↓ʔgi↓

OBS	REM	ATEL declare	WRK	this	cloak
-----	-----	--------------	-----	------	-------

‘This Elf declares:’

Ứrú gan ún xúsưrôngi tsíro túr xún tchú'i ta-rutí nán.

<i>ừứ</i>	<i>gan</i>	<i>ún</i>	<i>xứsựrongi</i>	<i>tsírq</i>	<i>tứr</i>	<i>xún</i>	<i>tchủ'i</i>	<i>ta-rựtí</i>
ừ ^{fj} ↓rừ ^{fj} ừ ^{fj} ↓	gga↓N?	ủ↓N?	çx ^h ừ ^h ↓sư ^{fj} ↓rư ^{k+} fjN?jgi↓	tổi↓rư ^{k+} fj	tư ^{fj} ↓rư	çx ^h ừ ^h ↓N?	ckçxư ^h fj↓i↓	ta↓rưư ^{fj} ↓tư↓
WKD	OBS	for	Master Carbonator	under	INV.0	NULL	three	POSS-ferrule

$$N^? \mathfrak{a}^{fg} \downarrow N^?$$

mine

‘[That there are] three Ferrules for the Master Carbonators under the mine’

Úrú gan ún isirongi chír cúr xún txadá irtototon cixítun'á.

<i>úrú</i>	<i>gan</i>	<i>ún</i>	<i>isirongi</i>	<i>chír</i>	<i>cúr</i>	<i>xún</i>	<i>txadq́</i>	<i>irtototon</i>
ũ ^{f̥d} ↓r _r ũ ^{f̥d} ↓	jgá↓N?	ũ↓N?	i _s i↓r _r ^{k+f̥g} N? ^{f̥g} jgi↓	çxi↓r _r	ckw ^x ũ ^{f̥g} ↓r _r	çx ^h ũ↓N?	ckçx ^h a↓d _e ^{f̥d} ↓	i↓r _r ^{k+f̥g} t _t ^{k+f̥g} k _k ^{f̥g} t _t ^{k+f̥g} N?
WKD	OBS	for	Collier	in	INV.-1	NULL	WO+7	seven

<i>cixí</i>	<i>tun'q</i>
cki ^{fg} ↓çx ^h r ^{fg} ↓	tur ^{fg} ↓nʔe ^{fg} ↓
hall	stone

‘[That there are] seven for the Colliers in their halls of stone’

Ýrú gan txadá cuncuton ún dun ça sán túsa úxí shanú dun túr shardo núgí.

[illegible]

shaqú *dun* *túr* *shardo* *núgí*
 $\text{ʃ}^{\text{h}}\text{a}^{\text{f}}\text{q}^{\text{f}}\downarrow\text{N}^?$ $\text{d}^{\text{u}}\text{w}\downarrow\text{N}^?$ $\text{t}^{\text{u}}\text{r}^{\text{f}}\downarrow\text{r}^{\text{f}}\text{r}$ $\text{ʃ}^{\text{h}}\text{a}^{\text{f}}\text{r}^{\text{f}}\text{d}^{\text{f}}\text{k}^{\text{f}}$ $\text{N}^?\text{u}^{\text{f}}\downarrow\text{g}^{\text{f}}\text{r}^{\text{f}}\text{q}^{\text{f}}\downarrow$
 retire NWK INV.o mortal human

‘[That there are] nine for Mortal Men [who are] doomed to retire’

Ún Sántá chíř túř isi ta-Sántá úřú gan txadá nangí shindí nurchq.

ún Sántá chíř túř isi ta-Sántá úřú gan
 ú↓N? s̥p̥^ǵ↓N?t̥p̥^ǵ↓ ĞX↓^ǵ t̥ú^ǵ↓^ǵ i↓š̥i↓ t̥a↓s̥p̥^ǵ↓N?t̥p̥^ǵ↓ ú^ǵ↓^ǵ ^ǵřú^ǵ↓^ǵ ^ǵga↓N?
 for The Chimney Man on INV.o red POSS-The Chimney Man WKD OBS
 txadá nangí shindí nurchq
 ĞĶĶ^ha↓^ǵ d̥p̥^ǵ↓ N?a↓N?j̥g̥^ǵ↓ š̥^hi↓N?d̥i↓ N?u↓^ǵ ^ǵř^ǵĶ^h↓^ǵ
 WO+7 one WO+10 throne

‘[That there is] one for The Chimney Man on His red throne’

Chír chířcā çonşq dun árxí xún txáçq ánrú.

chír chířcā çonşq dun árxí xún txáçq ánrú
 ĞX↓^ǵ ^ǵř^ǵĶ^h↓^ǵ ĞX↓^ǵ ^ǵř^ǵĶ^h↓^ǵ c̥ka^ǵ↓ Ķ^h↓^ǵ N?š̥^h↓^ǵ d̥u↓N? e↓^ǵ ^ǵř^ǵĶ^h↓^ǵ Ķ^h↓^ǵ ú↓N? ĞĶĶ^ha↓^ǵ c̥ka^ǵ↓ e↓N? ^ǵřú^ǵ↓^ǵ
 at where reside NWK INV.+2 NULL the North Pole shadow

‘At the North Pole where the Shadows lie.’

Ún ta-dorā nangí ta-rutí

ún ta-dorā nangí ta-rutí
 ú↓N? t̥a↓^ǵ d̥^h↓^ǵ ^ǵř^ǵa^ǵ↓ N?a↓N?j̥g̥^ǵ↓ t̥a↓^ǵ ^ǵřú^ǵ↓^ǵ t̥i↓^ǵ
 for POSS-rule one POSS-ferrule
 ‘One Ferrule to rule,’

Ún ta-shũnsí úřú txadá shú.

ún ta-shũnsí úřú txadá shú.
 ú↓N? t̥a↓^ǵ š̥^hú^ǵ↓^ǵ N?š̥^h↓^ǵ ^ǵř^ǵú^ǵ↓^ǵ ĞĶĶ^ha↓^ǵ d̥p̥^ǵ↓ š̥^hú^ǵ↓^ǵ
 for POSS-find WKD WO+7 all
 ‘To find them all’

Ún ta-xítí nangí ta-rutí

ún ta-xítí nangí ta-rutí
 ú↓N? t̥a↓^ǵ Ķ^h↓^ǵ t̥i↓^ǵ N?a↓N?j̥g̥^ǵ↓ t̥a↓^ǵ ^ǵřú^ǵ↓^ǵ t̥i↓^ǵ
 for POSS-bring one POSS-ferrule
 ‘One Ferrule to bring,’

Ún ta-tsantú chíř xurgí.

ún ta-tsantú chíř xurgí
 ú↓N? t̥a↓^ǵ t̥sa↓N?t̥ú↓ ĞX↓^ǵ ^ǵř^ǵ Ķ^hú^ǵ↓^ǵ ^ǵř^ǵg̥i^ǵ↓^ǵ
 for POSS-bind in arctic
 ‘To bind [them] in the Arctic.’

4.2.5 Notes

The sentence *Úřú gan txadá cuncutq ún dun cā sán túsā úxí shqnú dun túř shardo núgí* is very complex and serves as a good illustration of some of the quirks of Elvish grammar:

- ◇ *úřú* /^ǵřú^ǵ↓^ǵ ^ǵřú^ǵ↓^ǵ/ marks that the entire clause is an object of the verb *tshúá* /^ǵš̥^hú^ǵ↓^ǵ ^ǵř^ǵú^ǵ↓^ǵ/ ‘declare’ in the first clause. It can be translated as the English subordinator ‘that’ in this context.
- ◇ The evidentiality marker *gan* /^ǵga↓N?/ qualifies the copula, which has no root. It is required here to prevent *úřú* from affecting only the following noun phrase, as it must precede a verb (marker) to affect the entire clause.
- ◇ *txadá cuncutq* /^ǵĶĶ^ha↓^ǵ d̥p̥^ǵ↓ c̥kú↓N?c̥kú↓^ǵ ^ǵř^ǵú^ǵ↓^ǵ/ is simply the word for the number 9 (whose default work order is w11) raised by 7 work orders to give it work order w4 to match *rutí* /^ǵřú^ǵ↓^ǵ t̥i↓^ǵ/ ‘ferrule’ in the second clause, which is elided here. Thus, this phrase literally means ‘nine of the thing with work order w4.’

- ◇ The complement of the PP headed by *ún* / $\text{ũ} \downarrow \text{N}^?$ / ‘for’ is the rest of the clause.

In particular, the relative clause *dun cq sán túsq úxí shaní dun túr shardo* ‘which are destined to retire’ is fairly complicated on its own:

- ◇ The NP it modifies, *shardo núgí* / $\text{ʂ}^{\text{h}}\text{a} \downarrow \text{r} \downarrow \text{d}^{\text{k}} \text{N}^? \text{ũ} \downarrow \text{j} \text{g} \text{r}^{\text{f}} \downarrow$ / ‘mortal humans’, follows the clause rather than preceding it.
- ◇ Notably, the relative pronoun *cq* / $\text{č} \text{k} \text{a}^{\text{f}} \downarrow$ / is not the first word in the clause. Rather, because it is the subject of a clause with a lazy verb, it is preceded by the lazy agent marker *dun* / $\text{d} \text{u} \downarrow \text{N}^?$ /.
- ◇ The complement of *túsq* / $\text{t} \text{ũ} \downarrow \text{ʂ} \text{a}^{\text{f}} \downarrow$ / ‘to be destined’ is yet another clause, viz. *shaní dun túr shardo* ‘the mortal ones retire’.
- ◇ This inner clause is preceded by the lazy theme marker *úxí* / $\text{ũ}^{\text{f}} \downarrow \text{č} \text{x}^{\text{h}} \text{r}^{\text{f}} \downarrow$ /, which marks that the clause is the theme of *túsq* / $\text{t} \text{ũ} \downarrow \text{ʂ} \text{a}^{\text{f}} \downarrow$ /.
- ◇ The sequence *túr shardo núgí* / $\text{t} \text{ũ}^{\text{f}} \downarrow \text{r} \downarrow \text{ʂ}^{\text{h}} \text{a} \downarrow \text{r} \downarrow \text{d}^{\text{k}} \text{N}^? \text{ũ} \downarrow \text{j} \text{g} \text{r} \downarrow$ / is SAP-contracted (see § 2.3.2.3) and is short for *túr shardo shardo núgí* / $\text{t} \text{ũ}^{\text{f}} \downarrow \text{r} \downarrow \text{ʂ}^{\text{h}} \text{a} \downarrow \text{r} \downarrow \text{d}^{\text{k}} \text{ʂ}^{\text{h}} \text{a} \downarrow \text{r} \downarrow \text{d}^{\text{k}} \text{N}^? \text{ũ} \downarrow \text{j} \text{g} \text{r} \downarrow$ /. That is, we have a SAP *túr shardo* / $\text{t} \text{ũ}^{\text{f}} \downarrow \text{r} \downarrow \text{ʂ}^{\text{h}} \text{a} \downarrow \text{r} \downarrow \text{d}^{\text{k}} \text{N}^?$ / ‘the mortal ones’, which agrees with *núgí* / $\text{N}^? \text{ũ} \downarrow \text{j} \text{g} \text{r}^{\text{f}} \downarrow$ / ‘human’ and its referent is the NP *shardo núgí* / $\text{ʂ}^{\text{h}} \text{a} \downarrow \text{r} \downarrow \text{d}^{\text{k}} \text{N}^? \text{ũ} \downarrow \text{j} \text{g} \text{r}^{\text{f}} \downarrow$ / ‘mortal humans’.

In sum, this sentence is a dependent clause that contains a relative clause whose theme is another clause, and both inner clauses either modify or reference an NP that occurs later on in the sentence.

4.2.6 Notes to add to the grammar.

- ◇ The interpunct is the only punctuation mark and functions as a full stop, semicolon, colon, and comma.
- ◇ The particle ‘that’ as in ‘I declare that’ is expressed by placing the theme marker before the verb of the ‘that’-clause, or before the entire clause if there is no verb (zero copula).
- ◇ In poetry, movement of nouns due to work order is restricted to within a line rather than within a clause.

4.2.7 Literal Translation of the Elvish Adaptation

This Elf declares:

That there are three Ferrules for the Master Carbonators under the mine

That there are seven for the Colliers in their stone-halls

That there are nine for Mortal Men [who are] destined to retire

That there is one for The Chimney Man on The Chimney Man’s red throne

At the North Pole where the Shadows reside

One Ferrule to rule, to find them all

One Ferrule to bring, to bind [them] in the Arctic.

At the North Pole where the Shadows reside

5 Appearance and Culture

5.1 Gender

Elves have no concept of gender and are each referred to as ‘it’. They also do not reproduce naturally and are instead all created by The Chimney Man.

5.2 The Carbonators

At the very top of Elvish society stands the council of Master Carbonators. This council consists of a dozen or so Elves who are assigned a work order of 3.

The council is ruled over by the Grand Carbonator. It is the sole Elf that is assigned a work order of 2, and who is thus considered equally important to the Elves as Coal itself. The Grand Carbonator is effectively the right-hand Elf of The Chimney Man and reports to Him in person every Christmas Eve.

5.3 Elvish Upper Class

The social classes of Collier and Master Carbonator comprise the upper classes of Elvish society; these Elves are easily identified as only they are entitled to wear *rŋngi* /r̥ŋ^{kʰŋ}Nʔŋgi↓/ ‘cloaks’. These cloaks come in three forms:

- ◇ Colliers wear crimson cloaks and are thus commonly referred to as *isirŋngi* /i↓s̥i↓r̥ŋ^{kʰŋ}Nʔŋgi↓/ ‘redcloaks’.
- ◇ Master Carbonators wear crimson cloaks embroidered with black patterns of Coal and are thus commonly referred to as *xúsŋrŋngi* /ç̥x̥^hũ↓s̥ur̥ŋ^{kʰŋ}Nʔŋgi↓/ ‘blackcloaks’.
- ◇ Finally, the Grand Carbonator’s cloak is entirely black and coated with Coal; for this reason, the Grand Carbonator is commonly referred to as *Shŋnxqŋrŋngi* /ʂ^{hkʰŋ}Nʔç̥x̥^hḁ↓r̥ŋ^{kʰŋ}Nʔŋgi↓/ ‘Coal cloak’.

Lower-class Elves who pretend to have a higher social class than they actually do are referred to as *ishŋrŋngi* /i↓ʂ̥^hũ↓r̥ŋ^{kʰŋ}Nʔŋgi↓/ ‘fake cloaks’; wearing a cloak that corresponds to a higher class than one’s own is generally punished by decommissioning (see § 5.4).

Other Elves do not wear any clothes at all. The common Elf instead keeps itself warm in the freezing temperatures of the Arctic by burning the Coal it consumes inside its ventral furnace.

5.4 ‘Retirement’

A central concept in Elvish society is *shŋnq* /ʂ̥^hũ↓ŋ^{kʰŋ}Nʔḁ↓/ ‘retirement’. Elves never stop working; that is, an Elf only ‘retires’ at the moment of its death. In some cases, Elves who have acted out of line or otherwise disrupted the Coal mining process—or worse, slighted The Chimney Man—can be ‘decommissioned’, which entails *actively* ‘retiring’ an Elf. This is also known as ‘dishonourable retirement’.

Elves that retire honourably are given a *Shŋnxqshŋnq* /ʂ̥^{hkʰŋ}Nʔç̥x̥^hḁ↓ʂ̥^hũ↓ŋ^{kʰŋ}Nʔḁ↓/ ‘Coal burial’, i.e. they are cremated in such a way as to turn them into Coal, thus contributing to Elvish society even after their demise.

5.5 Refurbishment

Refurbishment is the act of promoting an Elf from a lower social class into a higher social class; this is a rare occurrence and only awarded to Elves for distinguished acts of service in the mines. For instance, a canary that consistently delivers twice the amount of Coal compared to its co-workers may be promoted to head miner after some time once new tunnels are constructed.

Similarly, a Head Miner that oversees a particularly large Coal mine or even several coal mines may eventually be promoted to a Collier if their area of management grows too large for an Elf of its status.

Upon becoming a Collier or Master Carbonator, an Elf is rewarded with a *rŋngi* /r̥ŋ^{kʰŋ}Nʔŋgi↓/ ‘cloak’, which is subsequently sewn onto it, thus completing the refurbishment process and clearly demarcating them as now part of a higher social class than its former peers.

Below the class of Collier, candidates for refurbishment are selected by Colliers. Candidates for the class of Collier are selected by the Master Carbonators, and candidates for the latter class directly

by The Grand Carbonator. An Elf cannot become The Grand Carbonator. If The Grand Carbonator retires, a new one is constructed by The Chimney Man.

Refurbishment has no corresponding opposite process: if an Elf does something that causes it to fall below its social class, only decommissioning awaits it.

5.6 Sleep

Elves never sleep prior to their retirement. In Elvish, there are indeed two different words for ‘sleeping’; one, *nurá* /Nʔur^h↓r^h↓/, which refers to the most sacred and noble hibernation of The Chimney Man, and which therefore naturally assigned a work order of 1 and which can indeed refer only to the sleep of The Chimney Man.

The other word, conversely, has word order 11 and is associated primarily with the sleep of humans and other lesser beings. Elves consider this form of sleep nothing but a waste of time.

Thus, it should also come as no surprise that The Chimney Man’s hibernating is considered a working verb, as The Chimney Man always works the Hardest and therefore His hibernation must obviously be some to the Elves unfathomable form of work. Normal sleeping, by contrast, is a lazy verb.

5.7 Physical Description

- ◇ Elves have no lips, making their sharp and pointy teeth, which are designed for the chewing and consumption of Coal, by which they are perpetually stained a dark and dusty black, clearly visible.
- ◇ Elvish tongues are extremely stiff and don’t bend.
- ◇ Elvish eyes are covered in multiple levels of eye lashes to keep the Coal out of their vision. Since the Elvish eye has evolved to thrive in an exceedingly dry and dusty environment, Elves naturally never need to close their eyes and thus lack eyelids.
- ◇ Elves have pointy ears, but they point downwards, so as to not collide with the low ceiling of their mines.
- ◇ Lower-class Elves (below the class of Collier) are typically always hunched down so as to fit in lower tunnels.
- ◇ Elves have inverted knees, so as to improve crawling in tunnel conditions.
- ◇ Elves are closer to Coal golems than biological creatures.
- ◇ The throat and mouth of an Elf is constantly extremely dry due to being coated in Coal dust, which renders their articulation extremely hoarse, strained, and outright grating.
- ◇ The complexion of an Elf is a dark grey, simply because they are always covered in layers upon layers of coal; no-one actually knows what the natural skin colour of an Elf is.
- ◇ Elves are mostly bald; the most hair they have on their bodies is their eye lashes.

5.8 Idioms

Since Coal is the most important aspect of Elvish society, many idioms and phrases in Elvish revolve around Coal and anything involved in the Coal mining process. For example, whereas in English a seam of Coal may be referred to as a ‘coal vein’ in analogy with the veins of the human body, Elvish does the opposite: the term *shú’i ta-xqro* /sh^hú^h↓i ta↓x^hq^h↓/ ‘blood vessel’ literally means ‘tunnel of blood’, where *shú’i* is the term for a tunnel in a Coal mine.

6 Dictionary

Lazy verbs are marked with *lz.*, working verbs with *wk.*, compound verbs with *cv.*

an /a^h↓N[?]/ *prep.*

1. Opposing, on the opposite side of.
2. More than. *When preceded by a number.*

ánrú /e↓N[?]↑rú^h↓/ *n. w11* Shadow.

ca /c̣ka^h↓/ *pron.* Which, who, what,. *Introduces a relative clause (see § 2.10.1).*

cáru /c̣ḳe↓↑ṛu↓/ *Work order lowering marker; see § 2.2.*

chír /ç̣xi↓↑ṛ/ *prep.* At, on, in, near, onto.

chírca /ç̣xi↓↑ṛc̣ka^h↓/ *pron.* [contraction of **chír** and **ca**, lit. ‘in which’] *Where. Introduces a locative relative clause (see § 2.10.1).*

chírru /ç̣xi↓↑ṛṛu↓/ *prep.* Into, towards.

chonsq /ç̣x^k↑N[?]↑ṣḳ↓/ *v. lz* Reside, live.

chornq /ç̣x^k↑↑ṛN[?]↑ḳ↓/ *n. w6*

1. Coworker.
2. Peer.

chunxi /ç̣xu^h↓N[?]↑ç̣x^h↓/ *n. w11* Head.

cícha /c̣ḳi^h↓↑ç̣xa^h↓/ *Work Order raising marker; see § 2.2.*

cirshú /c̣ki↓↑ṛṣḥú↓/ *adj. w1*

1. Awake. *Used solely in reference to The Chimney Man.*
2. The number 2.

cixí /c̣ki^h↓↑ç̣x^h↑/ *n. w11* Hall.

cuncu /c̣ku↓N[?]↑c̣ku↓/ *n. w11* [sense 2 is a calque of Santaa ^hh]

1. Logistics.
2. The number 8.

cuncutq /c̣ku↓N[?]↑c̣ku↓↑ṭḳ↓N[?]/ *n. w11* [from **cuncu** and **tq**; literally ‘logistics more’, a calque of Santaa ^hh ^hh] The number 9.

dácha /ḍe^h↓↑ç̣xa^h↓/ *n. w11* Table.

dánchi /ḍe↓N[?]↑ç̣xi↓/ *n. w2* A vein of Coal.

dígá /ḍi^h↓↑j̣g̣e↓/ *n. w11* Cane.

dishá /ḍi↓ṣḥe^h↓/ *adv.*

1. Always. *In a sentence with positive polarity.*
2. Never. *In a sentence with negative polarity.*

dora /ḍo^k↑↑ṛa^h↓/ *v.*

1. *wk* To rule, reign (+WKD over sbd./sth.).

gan /j̣ga↓N[?]/ *particle* [from **gantú**] *Evidentiality marker; see § 2.7.6.*

gantú /j̣ga↓N[?]↑ṭú↓/ *v.* To see.

gincú /j̣gi^h↓N[?]↑c̣ḳú↓/ *Work order lowering marker; see § 2.2.*

ginun → **gisq**

giron → **gisq**

gisq /j̣gi^h↓↑ṣa^h↓N[?]/ *adv.* **AWK** **gisq**, **REM** **ginun**, **NR1** **gixí**, **NR2** **giron**, **NR3** **giron**. *Particle that expresses a temporal relationship. This word has 5 forms, each of which corresponds to a tense; its exact meaning depends on the tense as well as the tense of the containing clause.*

1. Now, in this moment, immediately. *If the tense matches the syntactic Present Tense of the clause.*
2. Soon, (soon) after, later. *If the tense matches the syntactic Future Tense of the clause.*
3. In the distant future. *If the tense matches the syntactic Future-in-the-Future Tense of the clause.*
4. Some time ago, before. *If the tense matches the syntactic Past Tense of the clause.*
5. Long ago, once upon a time. *If the tense matches the syntactic Pluperfect Tense of the clause.*

gixí → **gisq**

gusha /j̣gu^h↓↑ṣha^h↓/ *v. lz* To crouch, be crouched.

igá /i↓j̣g̣e^h↓/ *n. w11* Poem.

ínú /i^h↓N[?]↑ú↓/ *n. w6* Minecart.

irgu /i↓↑ṛṛgu^h↓/ *v.* [sense 2 is a calque of Santaa ^hh]

1. To build.
2. The number 4.

irtq /i↓↑ṛṛṭḳ↓N[?]/ *n. w11* [from **irgu** and **tq**; literally ‘build more more’, a calque of Santaa ^hh ^hh] The number 5.

irtqtq /i↓↑ṛṛṭḳ↓↑ṭḳ↓N[?]/ *n. w11* [from **irgu** and **tq**; literally ‘build more more’, a calque of Santaa ^hh ^hh ^hh] The number 6.

irtqtqtq /i↓↑ṛṛṭḳ↓↑ṭḳ↓↑ṭḳ↓N[?]/ *n. w11* [from **irgu** and **tq**; literally ‘build more more more’, a calque of Santaa ^hh ^hh ^hh ^hh] The number 7.

ishú /i↓ṣḥú↓/ *n. w11*

1. Charcoal.
2. *fig.* Something that is fake or wrong; fraud; impostor.

ishúrongi /i↓ṣḥú↓↑ṛḳ↓N[?]↑j̣gi↓/ *n. w11* [from **ishú** and **rongi**] *Someone who pretends to have a higher social class than they actually do. Lit. ‘false cloak’; see § 5.3.*

isi /i↓ṣi↓/ *adj. w11* Red.

isirongi /i↓ṣi↓↑ṛḳ↓N[?]↑j̣gi↓/ *n. w4* [from **isi** and **rongi**] *Collier. Lit. ‘redcloak’; see § 5.3.*

nq /N[?]↑ṿ↓N[?]/ *n. w6* Coal mine.

nánchun /NʰəŋʰNʰŋxʉNʰ/ *n. w5* [from **nánrú** ‘canary’ and **chunxi** ‘head’] Head Miner.

nángá /NʰəŋʰNʰŋgəŋʰ/ *n. w11* Communication.

nángásánshú /NʰəŋʰNʰŋgəŋʰsəŋʰNʰŋhʉŋʰ/ *n. w6* [from **nángá** and **sánshú**, lit. ‘workplace communication’] The Elvish language.

nangí /Nʰaŋʰŋgəŋʰ/ *n. w11* [sense 2 is a calque of Santaa *hō*]

1. December.

2. The number 1.

nánrú /NʰəŋʰNʰŋrʉŋʰ/ *n.* [from **nán**]

1. w7 Coal miner.

2. w6 Elf, canary. *All Elves are coal miners, whence this sense follows naturally. This is the Generic term for an Elf whose social status is unknown, as well as the term for Canaries.*

náru /NʰəŋʰNʰŋrʉŋʰ/ *n. w1* [from **nurá**]

1. Hibernation. *Used solely in reference to The Chimney Man’s hibernation.*

2. *fig.* Hibernation cycle, year. *A time period equal in length to a full hibernation cycle of The Chimney Man, which is approximately one year.*

natá /Nʰaŋʰtəŋʰ/ *Work Order raising marker; see § 2.2.*

ní /Nʰŋʰŋ/ *adj.* Some, a certain.

norta /Nʰŋʰŋtəŋʰ/ *adj. or n.* Grey. *The colour of stone, never Coal; for Coal, xúsú ‘black’ is used instead.*

núgí /Nʰŋʰŋgəŋʰ/ *n. w11* Human, man, woman. *Elves do not distinguish between gender in other species as they have no gender themselves.*

núnrá /Nʰŋʰŋrʉŋʰ/ *v. wk.* [from **nánrú**]

1. To mine Coal.

2. To be alive.

3. *cv.* **núnrá chírru** To discover, uncover, find, encounter by chance. *Lit. ‘To mine into.’*

nurá /Nʰŋʰŋrʉŋʰ/ *v. w1* To hibernate. *Used solely in reference to The Chimney Man’s hibernation.*

nurchə /Nʰŋʰŋrʉŋʰ/ *n. w11* Throne.

ondo /kʰNʰŋŋkʰ/ *v. wk.* To hand in, deliver. *Specifically, this word means ‘to deliver the result of some work (generally Coal) to one’s superiors’ and is used both by low-ranking Elves to describe the process of handing in the Coal one has mined at the end of every day, as well as by high-ranking Elves to report the amount of Coal mined by their subordinates to their superiors on a regular basis.*

oxa /kʰŋʰhəŋʰ/ *Work order lowering marker; see § 2.2.*

raco /rʉŋʰŋckʰ/ *v. wk*

1. To go.

2. **raco chírru** + PTCP To begin.

rárchí /rʉŋʰŋrʉŋʰŋiŋʰ/ *v. wk.* To sew.

rıçá /rʉŋʰŋckəŋʰ/ *pron.* [contraction of **rıdu** and **çá**] When. *Introduces a temporal relative clause (see § 2.10.1).*

rıdu /rʉŋʰŋdʉŋʰ/ *adv.* Then, afterwards.

ringú /rʉŋʰŋŋŋŋŋ/ *n. w11* Handle.

rə- /rʉŋʰŋ/ *particle* Collective marker; see § 2.4.

rəngi /rʉŋʰŋŋŋŋŋ/ *n. w4*

1. Cloak. *This specifically refers to a type of cloak worn only by Colliers and Master Carbonators.*

2. Elf (upper class). *This term refers to Elves of the class of Collier and above. Formally, only Elves who are themselves Colliers or higher are allowed to use rəngi on its own to refer to a high-class Elf. See also § 2.6.2.*

rəsa /rʉŋʰŋsəŋʰ/ *v. lz.* To slide.

rutí /rʉŋʰŋtʉŋʰ/ *n. w4* Ferrule.

rúxə /rʉŋʰŋŋŋhəŋʰ/ *n. w11*

1. Instance, a singular event.

2. *Forms multiplier numerals when preceded by a number and ta-. In this sense, this word has no work order and does not impose any constraints upon the word order of the sentence.*

◇ **tchú’i ta-rúxə** ‘Three times.’

◇ **irgú ta-rúxə ta-dánchi** ‘Four times as many coal veins.’

sán /səŋʰNʰ/ *particle* [reduced form of **sán**] Evidentiality marker; see § 2.7.6.

sán /səŋʰŋNʰ/ *n. w11* Being.

sánshú /səŋʰŋŋŋŋŋŋŋ/ *n. w11* Workplace.

Sántá /səŋʰŋŋŋŋŋŋŋ/ *n. w1* [from **sán** and **tá**; direct borrowing from Santaa *hō òh ōh hō òh ōh hqql*] The Chimney Man. *Always capitalised, unless derogatory lowering is applied. This noun is never declined for number as there is, has been, and will only ever be one Chimney Man.*

sántə /səŋʰŋŋŋŋŋŋŋ/ *n. w11*

1. Place.

2. **chír ní sántə** There (expletive). *Lit. ‘in a certain place’; used as the subject of verbs that don’t have a semantic agent and can stand on its own with a (zero) copula to signify ‘there is.’*

3. +**chír** and DEM Here, there. *Preceded by **chír** ‘in’ and a demonstrative pronoun, lit. ‘In this/that place’. The proximal pronoun is used to mean ‘here’, the medial pronoun to mean ‘there (medial)’, and the distal pronoun to mean ‘there (distal)’.*

sár /sə↓r̥/ prep.

1. With.
2. For, over the course of. *Only when followed by a time period.*

sárgá /sə↓r̥gə/ v.

1. wk To hold, hold on to.
2. lz To keep, retain.
3. lz To keep a secret, hide away.

sargú /sə↓r̥gú/ v. lz

1. To show.
2. lz. dep. **sargú norta** To run dry, be empty. *This is a deponent verb, i.e. the subject is in the MAN form. Lit. ‘To show grey’, alluding to the fact that a mostly black Coal vein gives way to grey stone once exhausted.*

shanú /ʃə↓a↓Nʔú/ v. lz [see also **shúná**] To retire.

shardo /ʃə↓a↓r̥d̥k̥/ adj. Mortal.

shatú /ʃə↓a↓tú/ Work order lowering marker; see § 2.2.

shindí /ʃə↓i↓Nʔdí/ Work Order raising marker; see § 2.2.

shindú /ʃə↓i↓Nʔdú/ Work order lowering marker; see § 2.2.

shítq /ʃə↓i↓t̥k̥/ Work Order raising marker; see § 2.2.

Shonxá /ʃə↓h̥k̥x̥a/ n. w2 Coal. *The most important noun in Elvish, second only to The Chimney Man. This word and all words derived from it are always capitalised.*

Shonxarongi /ʃə↓h̥k̥x̥a↓r̥ŋgi/ n. w2 [from **Shonxá** and **rongi**] Grand Carbonator. *Lit. ‘coal cloak’; see § 5.3.*

Shonxashúná /ʃə↓h̥k̥x̥a↓ʃə↓a↓Nʔa/ n. w2 [from **Shonxá** and **shúná**] Coal burial. *See § 5.4.*

shú /ʃə↓ú/ n. w11

1. Whole, entirety, everything.
2. All, every. *Used like a number.*

shú’i /ʃə↓ú’i/ n. w11

1. A tunnel in a Coal mine.
2. **shú’i ta-xaro** Blood vessel. *Lit. ‘blood tunnel’.*

shúná /ʃə↓ú’i↓Nʔa/ n. w4 [see also **shanú**] Retirement. *See § 5.4.*

shunsí /ʃə↓h̥u↓Nʔs̥i/ v.

1. lz To encounter, meet.
2. wk To find, discover.

sqtá /s̥k̥t̥a/ v.

1. lz To know.
2. wk To learn.

sqtarú /s̥k̥t̥a↓r̥ú/ n. w6 [from **sqtá**] Teacher.

súnno /s̥ú↓Nʔn̥o/ n.

1. Slate.
2. *Elvish given name.*

ta- /t̥a↓/ particle Possessive marker; see § 2.4.

- ◇ **ta-Sántá** ‘of The Chimney Man’
- ◇ **ríngú isi ta-dígá** ‘handles of red canes’

tá- /t̥e↓/ particle Archaic form of **tá-**.

tá /t̥e↓/ n. w4 Chimney.

tandí /t̥a↓Nʔdí/ n. w11

1. Shovelful. *Elvish unit of mass, approximately 37.12~kg.*

tchanú /t̥k̥x̥a↓Nʔú/ Work order lowering marker; see § 2.2.

tchatú /t̥k̥x̥a↓t̥u/ n. w11 Work.

tchichá /t̥k̥x̥i↓x̥e/ Work order lowering marker; see § 2.2.

tchixi /t̥k̥x̥i↓x̥hi/ Work Order raising marker; see § 2.2.

tchú’i /t̥k̥x̥ú’i/ n. w11 [sense 2 is a calque of Santaa **ôh**]

1. Plan.
2. The number 3.

tchúrshu /t̥k̥x̥ú’i↓r̥ʃu/ n. w11 Idiot, moron. *This is derogatory and thus always has word order 11.*

tqon /t̥k̥t̥q̥Nʔ/ adj. More.

tqrxí /t̥k̥t̥q̥r̥x̥i/ n.

1. Shale.
2. *Elvish given name.*

tsan’o /t̥s̥a↓Nʔo/ Work order lowering marker; see § 2.2.

tsantú /t̥s̥a↓Nʔt̥u/ v. wk To bind.

tshí’á /t̥ʃə↓i’á/ n. w1

1. Christmas.
2. The number 25.

tshigu /t̥ʃə↓i’g̥u/ adj. Bountiful, rich, plentiful.

tsho’q /t̥ʃə↓h̥k̥t̥q̥/ n. w11 Ribbon.

tshú’á /t̥ʃə↓ú’á/ v. wk. To declare, make known.

tsíro /t͡sʰi↓r̥kʰf̥/ *prep.* Under, beneath, below.

tsún /t͡sʰu̯ʰf̥↓Nʔ/ *particle* Evidentiality marker; see § 2.7.6.

tunʹá /t͡u̯ʰf̥↓Nʔr̥eʰf̥↓/ *n.* w11 Stone.

túsa /t͡u̯ʰs̥aʰf̥↓/ *v.* lz To be destined to ... *The object of this verb is a clause; the nested clause has no evidentiality marker.*

txá /t͡k̚çxʰeʰf̥↓/ *particle* [from **txáca**] Evidentiality marker; see § 2.7.6.

txáca /t͡k̚çxʰeʰf̥↓t͡kaʰf̥↓/ *n.* w3 The North Pole.

txadá /t͡k̚çxʰa↓d̥eʰf̥↓/ *Work Order raising marker*; see § 2.2.

txoncu /t͡k̚çxʰkʰf̥↓Nʔt͡ku̯ʰf̥↓/ *n.*

1. Granite.

2. Elvish given name.

txúdí /t͡k̚çxʰu̯ʰf̥↓d̥i↓/ *adj.* Fat, big.

txúnsha /t͡k̚çxʰu̯ʰf̥↓Nʔʂʰa↓/ *Work Order raising marker*; see § 2.2.

ún /u̯ʰ↓Nʔ/ *prep.*

1. For.

2. To, towards.

3. In order to, so as to. *Always followed by a verb prefixed with ta-*.

◇ **ún ta-shunsí** ‘in order to find’. *Lit. ‘for of [to] find’.*

úncho /u̯ʰf̥↓Nʔçxʰkʰ/ *Work Order raising marker*; see § 2.2.

xángá /çxʰeʰf̥↓Nʔj̥ge↓/ *n.* w11 Thing.

xaro /çxʰaʰf̥↓r̥kʰ/ *n.* w11 Blood.

xíntí /çxʰr̥f̥↓Nʔt̥i↓/ *Work Order raising marker*; see § 2.2.

xítj /çxʰr̥f̥↓t̥iʰf̥↓/ *v.* wk To bring, carry.

xonchu /çxʰkʰf̥↓Nʔçxu̯ʰf̥↓/ *Work order lowering marker*; see § 2.2.

xún /çxʰu̯ʰ↓Nʔ/ *adj.*

1. Proper, good.

2. Null adjective used in extraposition. See § 2.3.2.2.

xúnna /çxʰu̯ʰ↓NʔNʔaʰf̥↓/ *Work Order raising marker*; see § 2.2.

xúnrá /çxʰu̯ʰ↓Nʔr̥re↓/ *Work order lowering marker*; see § 2.2.

xurgi /çxʰu̯ʰ↓r̥r̥giʰf̥↓/ *n.* w3 The Arctic.

xúsú /çxʰu̯ʰ↓s̥u̯ʰf̥↓/ *adj.* w11 Black.

xúsurongi /çxʰu̯ʰ↓s̥u̯ʰf̥↓r̥kʰf̥↓Nʔj̥gi↓/ *n.* w3 [from **xúsú** and **rongi**] Master Carbonator. *Lit. ‘black-cloak’; see § 5.3 which are embroidered with black Coal-like patterns.*